American Sovereign Bullion

The View Through the Windshield

A TIME FOR GOLDMAN SACHS. A TIME FOR SACKS OF GOLD.



The Roadmap from 2000 to 2026,
and What the Indicators Are Telling Us Now

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A PERSONAL WORD BEFORE YOU BEGIN

The View Through the Windshield

Sadly, most people will only ever see a recession through the rearview mirror. They feel it first in the pit of the stomach, months after it already started, the morning they open a statement they wish they hadn't. By then the damage is done. A lifetime took forty years to build, and a downturn can take a third of it in eighteen months. All that's left to do is wait, and hope, and hope there'll be a climb back up a hill you didn't know you were choosing to be standing at the bottom of.

This guide is about the other view. ***The one through the windshield. All you need, is clarity.*** Here is the thing almost nobody tells you. Recessions[1] are not random acts of God. Since World War II we have had thirteen of them, and there are milestones we pass as we head into them, that we pass before each one of them. The same recurring handful of warning signs, milestones, show up before the road drops out from under the market, over and over. Cyclical. You do not need a crystal ball to read them. You need a map.

We have been keeping one for a long time. On the pages that follow, we are going to lay it out flat on the kitchen table and walk it with you, mile by mile, from the year 2000 to right now, in 2026. No noise. No doom for the sake of doom. Just where we have been, where we are, and what the signs are saying.

Read it carefully. Then, if it speaks to you, pick up the phone.

From all of us at American Sovereign Bullion



> **"American Sovereign Bullion is the only company I recommend for physical gold and silver and I don't lend my name to anyone I don't trust."**

Larry Kudlow,
Host of Fox Business Network's "Kudlow"

Larry Kudlow is a paid spokesperson for American Sovereign Bullion.

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THERE IS A TIME FOR EACH

“There is a time for Goldman Sachs. And there is a time for sacks of gold”.

That is not a knock on Wall Street. The stock market is a wonderful tool when the climate is right, the same way sailing the open seas is wonderful with the wind at your back. When the economy is expanding and the market is climbing, that is the season for stocks, and you ride it. We are not anti-stock. We are anti-***getting caught in the wrong season***.

We can all agree, seasons turn. We live in Florida, where half the people you meet from October to March are not from here. **Our population increases signifi cantly during that period of time. A seasonal relocation…** When the cold comes north, they do not sit in the snow and tough it out. They drive down to where the sun is still out. Your money can do the very same thing. When the climate in the stock market turns cold, there has historically been a place it could go where the sun was still shining. When Fall and Winter set in for stocks, it's Spring and Summer for gold and silver.

> ***THE WHOLE IDEA IN ONE LINE***
> ***Grass is green, you are in stocks. The grass turns brown, you move to gold. It greens up again, you move back. Two assets, two seasons. The only trick is knowing which season you are standing in. The rest of this guide is about how to tell.***

Through the Windshield, Not the Rearview

Here is the problem with how most people invest. They drive looking in the rearview mirror.

They find out there was a recession after it has already run them over. The news confirms it months later. The statement shows the damage. And the advisor says th e words every retiree has heard at least once, “stay the course, it always comes back.” Maybe it does. But if you are sixty-eight years old, “it comes back eventually” is not a plan. It is a hope with a necktie on.

We would rather hand you the windshield.

No one has a crystal ball, and we will never pretend we do. But you do not need one to drive a road that has already been driven thirteen times. Since World War II the United States has had thirteen recessions, three of them since the year 2000 alone. Every one was preceded by the same kind of warning signs. That is not superstition. That is a pattern with seventy years of data behind it.

Lewis and Clark did not have a satellite. They had a compass, and they wrote down the terrain as they crossed it so the next person through would know what was coming. That is all a map is. And if you are lost in the woods holding a compass, you do not stand there arguing with the needle. You go the way it points.



The four switches described below, traced on the gold and stock curves. Indexed to $100 at 2000. Sources: S&P Dow Jones Indices, LBMA.

The Roadmap, 2000 to 2026

Let us walk the map together, starting in the year 2000. Two assets, side by side, over the last twenty-six years.

1

Phase one, 2000 to 2002
The dot-com bubble was at its peak. The signs were all there, sky-high valuations, pure euphoria, everybody all in. The market topped, rolled over into the 2001 recession, and stocks fell hard. Gold, left for dead near $280 an ounce[2], began to wake up.

2

Phase two, 2002 to 2007
The bottom ca me in. Stocks were cheap again and the climate turned warm. This was the season for Goldman Sachs. The S&P 500 roughly doubled off its low[3].

3

Phase three, 2007 to 2009
The same signs came back, this time in housing and credit. The market peaked in October 2007, and then came the worst crash since the Great Depression, down about 57 percent. Gold went the other way[4].

4

Phase four, 2009 to today
The bottom came in March 2009. Stocks were on sale, the climate turned warm, and it stayed warm a long time. From 2009 to 2026 the market has run one of the great bull markets in history[5].

Now here is the que stion worth sitting with. What if you had simply followed the map? What if, at each top, you moved from Goldman Sachs into sacks of gold, and at each bottom, you moved back?

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Watch a single $100,000 move at each turn.

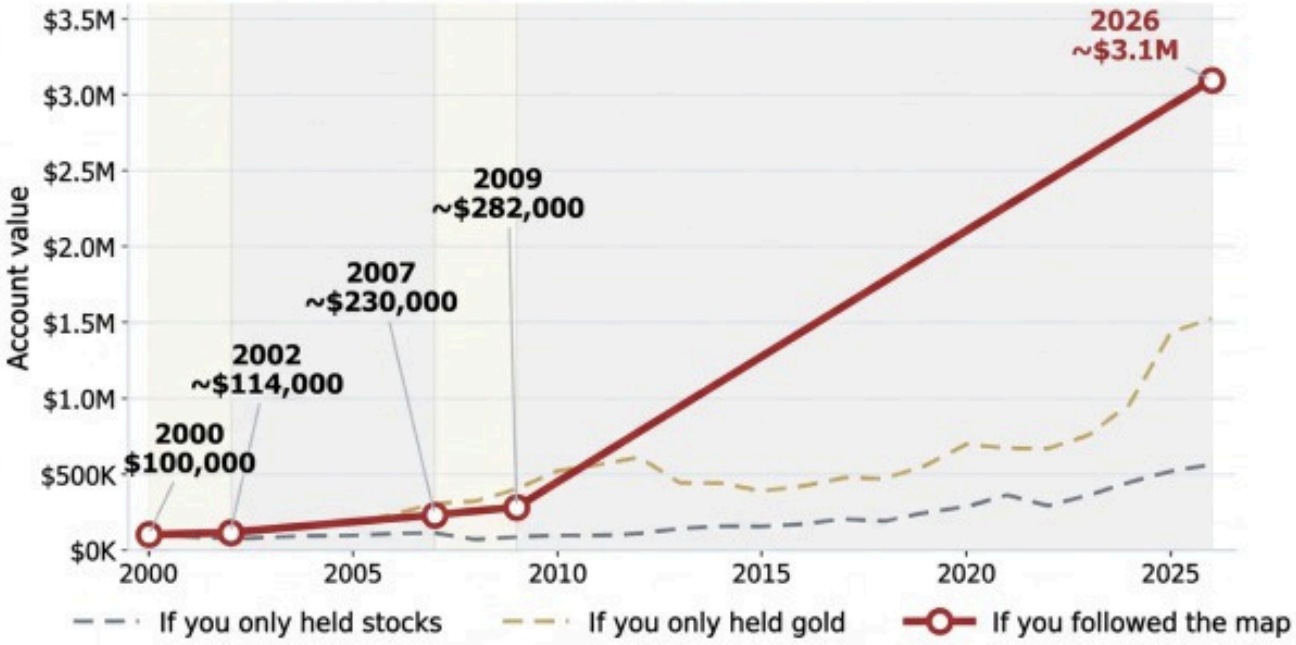
You start in 2000 and put the $100,000 into gold. By the bottom of the dot-com bust in 2002, it has grown to about $114,000. At that bottom you move it into stocks, and riding the 2002 to 2007 recovery it becomes about $230,000. In 2007, with the same warning signs flashing, you move back to gold, and through the 2008 crash it grows to about $282,000 while the market falls apart around it. At the March 2009 bottom you move into stocks one last time and ride the longest bull market in history. By 2026, that $282,000 has become roughly $3.1 million.[6]

Years	You held	Grew from	Grew to
200 0-2002	Gold	$100,000	~$114,000
2002-2007	Stocks	~$114,000	~$230,000
2007-2009	Gold	~$230,000	~$282,000
2009-2026	Stocks	~$282,000	~$3.1 million



Here is that same journey drawn out, next to two simpler choices, holding only stocks the whole time, or holding only gold the whole time.

The Map: What $100,000 Could Have Become

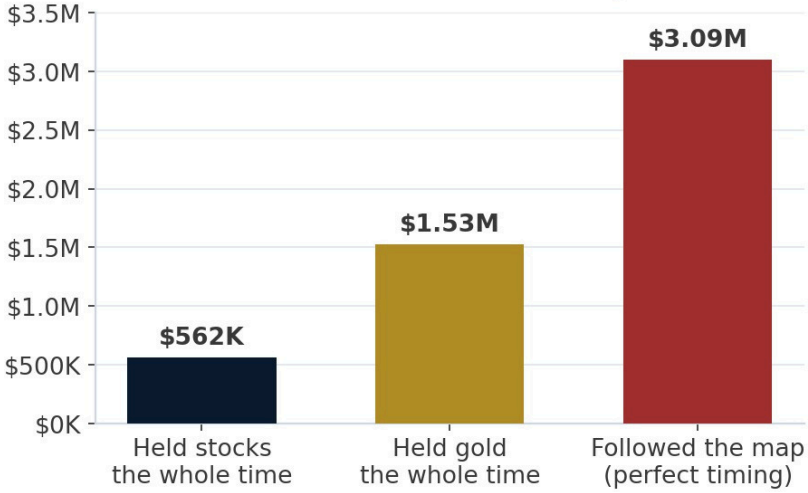


Hypothetical, perfect-timing illustration. Assumes buying and selling at the exact turning points, which no one can do. Price returns only; excludes dividends, taxes, storage and dealer premiums. Not a prediction. See disclosures.

STRAIGHT TALK

Nobody catches every top and bottom to the day. That $3.1 million number assumes perfect timing, and perfect timing does not exist. We are showing you the shape of the road, not promising you the exact mileage. So let us show you something that needs no timing at all.

What $100,000 Becomes by 2026



Price return only, 2000-2026. Excludes dividends, storage, premiums, and taxes

If you had done nothing but buy gold in 2000 and hold it, no trading, no timing, no clever moves, that same $100,000 would be worth about $1.5 million today. Buy and hold the stock market over the same stretch and you would have around $560,000. Gold, just held, beat the market over the last twenty-six years. That is not a forecast. That is the tape.

Where We Are Right Now

So where are we on the map in 2026? Look through the windshield. The same signs that showed up before 2000 and before 2007 are back on the dashboard.

Valuations are stretched to a historic extreme. The market's CAPE ratio, a standard measure of how expensive stocks are against their long-run earnings, is sitting near 41. In about 155 years of data, it has been higher exactly one time, the dot-com peak[7]. It is higher today than it was right before the 2008 crash.

The most respected investor alive is sitting in cash. Warren Buffett's Berkshire Hathaway is holding a record pile of cash and Treasury bills, nearly $400 billion, the largest in the company's history[8]. He is not buying. At his last shareholder meeting he said plainly that he has never seen people in “a more gambling mood than now.”[9]When the man who wrote the book on buying low is holding the biggest stack of cash of his life, that is a signal worth reading.

None of this tells you the day. Nobody can tell you the day. It tells you the ***season***. And through the windshield, this looks a great deal like a top.

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The Honest Case for Moving a Piece Now

Here is what we are ***not*** saying. We are not saying sell everything. We are not saying gold only. We are not telling you to bet the farm on a hunch.

We are saying move a piece.

Most of our clients move somewhere between fifteen and twenty-five percent of their retirement savings into physical gold and silver. Not all of it. A portion. The portion that lets you sleep at night.

Think of it the way you think about insurance. You insure your house not because you expect it to burn down, but because you cannot afford the one time it does. A portion of your savings in physical metal is insurance on the rest. You hope you never need it. You are very glad to have it the year you do.

And think about what you are protecting against. If your savings sit in the bank and in the stock market, you are betting on the same horse. Everything you own is leaning the same direction. When good people have everything in one pot, all leaning one way, they are carrying a risk they often cannot even see. A piece in physical gold is the one piece that is not leaning with the rest.

THE PROMISE YOU ALREADY MADE

You spent forty years building this. And somewhere in 2008 or 2009, watching it bleed, you told yourself you would never get caught flat-footed like that again. This is that promise, come back around. Moving a piece now, before the season turns, is simply how you keep it.



Why You Never Get the Call

People ask us all the time, “if a downturn is really coming, why won't my broker call me and tell me to get out?”

Fair question. The honest answer is not that your broker is a bad person. Most are decent, hardworking people. The answer is structural, and once you see it you cannot un-see it.

Picture a wall. On your side stands a retail advisor on a salary, whose pay is tied to how much of your money stays under his management. “Long term investors always win”, we’ve heard. You are trading for retirement. If you were to move a piece out, his book shrinks. He is simply not built to make that call.

On the other side of that wall, the Institutional side, are the traders who move the firm's own money. They are not trading for retirement. They get paid bonuses in December on what they earned in the first eleven months of the year. In a year that starts to turn sketchy, like 1999, like 2008, they head for the exits early to lock in the bonus to be as large as it could be that year, the year of the Recession. They do the selling. You do not get a phone call, because you are always standing on the retail side of the wall.

We are not here to run down an entire industry. We are here to tell you which side of the wall you are standing on, and that the call you have been waiting for is one the system was never designed to make. So we will make it. That, in one sentence, is the whole reason this guide exists.



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Straight Talk, in Three Steps

At American Sovereign Bullion we keep it simple. When you call, here is exactly what happens.

First, we tell you what we actually see in the market. Not the noise. Not the doom-scrolling. Not a sales pitch. Just the map, where we are on it, and why. Our job on that first call is to help you think clearly, nothing more.

Second, we answer every question you have. Including the ones you feel a little nervous to ask. There is no such thing as a dumb question here, and you will never be rushed.

Third, if it is right for you, we handle the details. We walk you through each step in plain English: the eligibility tax-free rollover, the IRS-approved depository that holds the metal in your name, and which metals to choose. And if it is not right for you, we will say so plainly. We would rather lose the sale than put you into something that does not fit your situation.

There is a time for Goldman Sachs. We believe this is a time for sacks of gold.

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PLEASE READ CAREFULLY

Important Disclosures

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Past performance does not guarantee future results. Both stocks and precious metals can fall in value, and gold can decline for extended periods. The historical figures shown are approximate and are drawn from public sources cited in the footnotes.

The market-timing illustration (“The Map”) is hypothetical. It assumes an investor bought and sold at the exact peaks and troughs, which no one can do consistently or reliably. It reflects price return only and excludes dividends on stocks as well as storage costs, dealer premiums, bid-ask spreads, and taxes on metals. Real-world results would be materially different and lower. The illustration is provided to explain a historical pattern, not to predict future returns, and nothing in it should be read as a promise that ASB can time the market on your behalf.

References to gold price comparison windows reflect a period that began near a multi-decade low for gold (around 2000) and runs to near an all-time high (2026). Starting and ending points materially affect any such comparison; a different window could show a materially different result.

Statements about the tax treatment of precious metals IRAs are based on current IRS rules and could change. Eligibility for a tax-free rollover depends on your specific situation. Consult a qualified tax professional. © 2026 American Sovereign Bullion. All rights reserved. 5301 N. Federal Hwy, Suite 245, Boca Raton, FL 33487.

Sources

Figures in this guide are footnoted to the sources below and were verified on a two-pass numeric check. Market and price values are point-in-time and move with the market.

- Recessions since WWII (13): NBER Business Cycle Dating Committee, via USAFacts.
- S&P 500 turning points and current level: S&P Dow Jones Indices; Yahoo Finance; CNBC.
- Gold prices (2000, 2007-09, 2026, Jan 2026 peak): LBMA Gold Price; CBS News.
- CAPE / Shiller P/E ~41 (second-highest in ~155 years): Robert Shiller data, via Yahoo Finance / The Motley Fool.
- Berkshire Hathaway record cash ~$397.4B (Q1 2026): CNN Business; Fortune; CNBC.
- Buffett “gambling mood” remark: Berkshire Hathaway annual meeting, May 2026, via CNBC.



REFERENCES

The following sources were consulted in the preparation of this guide. Numbered references in the body text correspond to the entries below.

[1]. **Page 3.** U.S. recession counts and dates per the National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER) Business Cycle Dating Committee; summarized by USAFacts, which counts thirteen recessions since World War II, the most recent in 2020.

[2]. **Page 6.** Gold ~$280/oz in 2000; ~$4,165/oz in June 2026; intraday peak ~$5,589/oz on January 29, 2026. Sources: LBMA Gold Price; CBS News.

[3]. **Page 6.** S&P 500 turning points (approx.): March 2000 high ~1,527; October 2002 low ~777; October 2007 high ~1,565; March 2009 low ~677. Source: S&P Dow Jones Indices; historical data via Yahoo Finance.

[4]. **Page 6.** Gold ~$750/oz (Oct 2007) to ~$920/oz (Mar 2009), approximate period prices. Source: LBMA Gold Price.

[5]. **Page 6.** S&P 500 level ~7,420 as of June 24, 2026. Source: Yahoo Finance / CNBC market data.

[6]. **Page 7.** Illustration assumes price-only returns and perfect timing at the exact turning points. It excludes dividends on stocks and storage costs, dealer premiums, spreads, and taxes on metals. It is not achievable in practice and is not a prediction. See Important Disclosures.

[7]. **Page 9.** Cyclically adjusted price-to-earnings (CAPE / Shiller P/E) ~41 in June 2026, described as the second-highest reading in roughly 155 years of data, behind only the dot-com peak. Source: Robert Shiller data, reported via Yahoo Finance / The Motley Fool.

[8]. **Page 9.** Berkshire Hathaway cash and U.S. Treasury bills ~$397.4 billion at the end of Q1 2026, a company record. Sources: CNN Business; Fortune; CNBC (May 2026).

[9]. **Page 9**. Warren Buffett, Berkshire Hathaway annual meeting, May 2026, as reported by CNBC.

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WHAT TO DO NEXT

The purpose of this guide is not to persuade you of a conclusion. It is to place the facts within reach — each verified against primary sources, each numbered in the References at the end — so that you can make an informed decision about the form in which your savings will meet the next chapter.

If you would like to speak with a specialist at American Sovereign Bullion about protecting your savings in physical gold and silver — or simply to ask the questions raised by this guide — we are here:



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